L E O

THE PHILOSOPHER

THE ARC OF THE DECALOGY

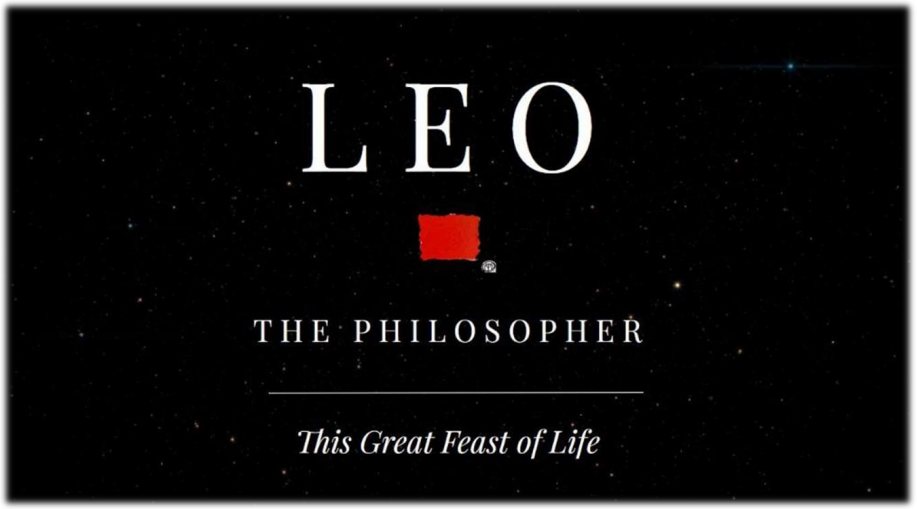
LEONARDO ALEXANDER DA GAMA

THE ALBANIA NOTEBOOKS
THE SOFIA DIARIES
THE PRAGUE CONFESSIONS
OPTIMUS MAXIMUS
A YOUNG FRENCH CHEF
MARCELLA
SHANGRI-LA NATION
T HE TOKYO DIARIES
TALES OF ODYSSIA
PARIS TO ISTANBUL

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L E O - *The Philosopher* is the serial, metafictional literary saga of Leonardo Alexander da Gama, a passionate artist-social philosopher in pursuit of reciprocal human rights by means of inclusive, secular democracy and a genuine democratic capitalism. From a youth in America's golden age of expansive freedoms, to a present-day lethal reckoning in ancestral Europe, protagonist Leo observes the collaborative achievements of humanity's moral Papyrus Era are crumbling under onslaught of ruthless, repressive neofascisms. Political, economic, theocratic – a new and amoral AI Digital Era is subsuming individuals and nations, byte by byte, expropriating natural freedoms worldwide.

Modern homage to *The Odyssey*, L E O – *The Philosopher* is a literary *Don Quixote*. He begins with THE BALKAN BADLANDS – *Till Death Do Us Part*, a trilogy set in Sofia, Tirana, and Prague. Opening with THE ALBANIA NOTEBOOKS – *In Defense of The Eagles*, Eastern Europe is a flashpoint for totalitarian repression. As invasive war in Ukraine rages, populist movements rise and fall, while shadowy Malignant Maligarchs swoop into the Balkans buying up its historic national treasures for pennies on the dollar. Cultural wars igniting intergenerational conflicts fuel political upheaval. The global struggle for reciprocal universal human rights is fundamental to Leo's tale. Knowing that evil triumphs when good people do nothing, Leo and his fellow guardians of secular democracy refuse to go gentle into that good night. *Did we not defeat the fascists before?* We did. *Will we now allow them to rise again?* Not on Leo and his friend's watch. Akin to Bond or Bourne, L E O offers thrilling humanist storytelling with a torchlight for future generations.

OSDG holds exclusive rights to author Marcy da Gama's L E O – *The Philosopher* series, and to its Wobbly Book® software app, an imaginative storytelling approach cross-blending text, audio, image, film and music in an all-in-one media suite. Audiences are able to enjoy L E O on any device, time, or screen with media choices transposable by preference. In essence, the Wobbly Book® empowers authors and commercial creatives to collaboratively develop new works

AN INDELICATE BALANCE OF NATURE

"Most people, Kamala, are like a falling leaf, which is blown and tossed through the air, and it flutters, and turns, and finally falls to the ground. But a few others, a very few, are like stars which travel one defined path: no wind reaches them, they have within themselves their guide and path."

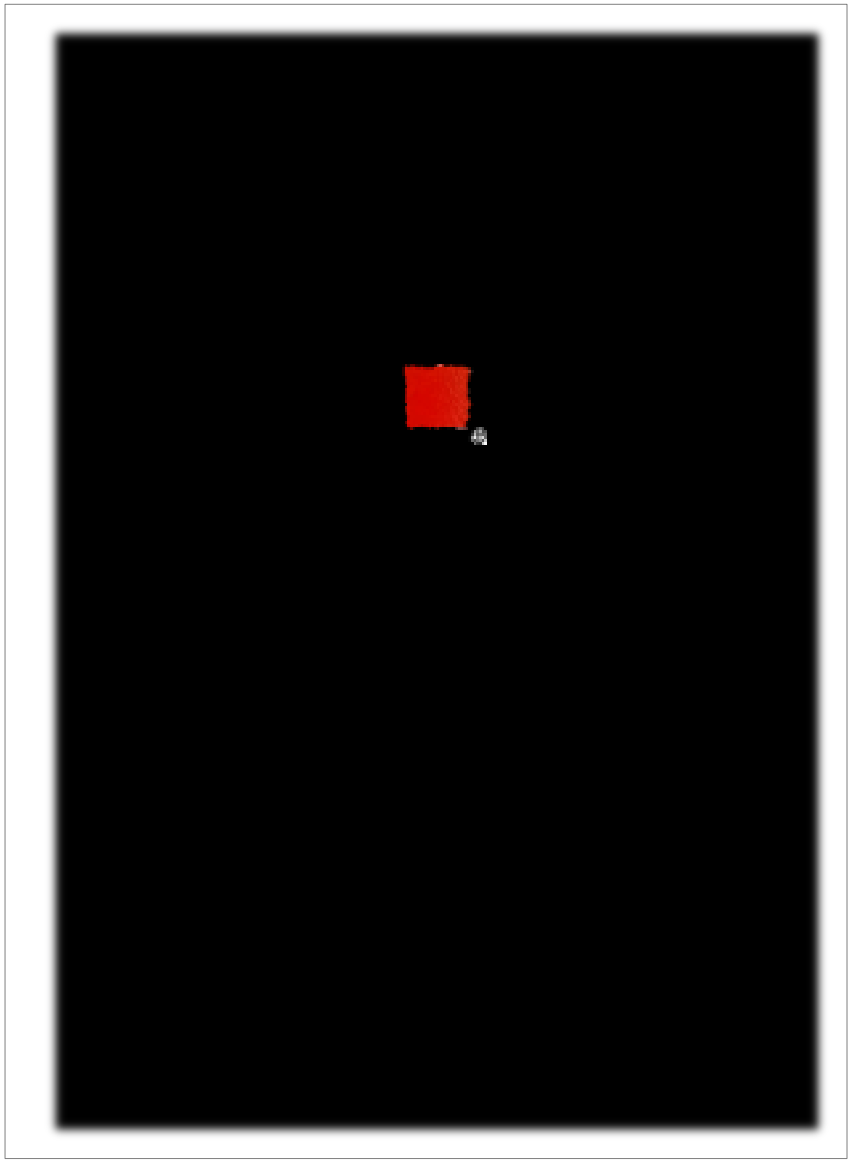
Leo da Gama, *boy reading wonder*, I was mesmerized by the powerful beauty of words to evoke feelings. Thrilling children's tales of Icarus, Daedalus, Cyclops, Minotaur; Zeus, Athena, Medea, Poseidon; Odysseus, Hercules, Argonauts, Sirens, the Greek classics were my youthful nourishment. I was an intensely sincere young boy, quite happy (save for as a four-year old my grandmother beating me senseless with wash-bleach fists). In fact, literature held a sway over my youth serving as a salve from the terrors that arise from being cast off to boarding school at four. Hearing shouts in the kitchen, "*Reading scholarships don't come along very often! They'll take Sissie, too!",* I kept reading as fast as I could. A charming story of a mustachioed fisherman on a sandy Mediterranean beach proudly displaying to an astonished young boy the freshly caught speckled fish flapping in his fancy sea nets. Like the boy, I was wondrously *astonished* by everything in life. It is my Achilles heel.

Grown, unpublished author in my early fifties, artist-social philosopher, I've kept the spark of youth. Enthusiasm for life is my calling card. Resting in the Balkans, the gunshot scar wound in my back aches like a leaden memory. I've sworn off drinking, although as social currency I often admire it. Keeping disciplined - *Stoic Shinto* – I remain a determined man, like one of Hesse's stars, traveling a defined path, no wind reaching me, having within myself guide and path. Shadow walker is the way of my world and it cannot not be helped.

Fancying myself a *Baudelairean de Tocqueville,* in Istanbul a shimmering blonde actress had spilled the tea about my misbegotten play, *Paris to Istanbul.* I had left America to return to *Europa,* thus fulfilling my Odyssean destiny, only to find that the liberating tone of Urbana, my heroine muse championing women's rights equal to any man, her blasphemy drove her movie-star producers mad. Enraged, they came after me with violent threats of my personal dismemberment – just the usual Islamist extremism. Recalling Falstaff's admonition that discretion was the better part of valor, with the aid of well-placed friends, I slipped onto a plane before my own love of figh if ting bad guys got the better of me. My grandfather, *Loudric*, and my *Uncle Arnold,* had fought fascists in Europe and their flesh bore the wounds of war. Marveling in boy awe, my small fingers touched their still fresh scars. Truth. I am rarely a reckless man. However, when I have to be, I am a humanist killer. Facts are facts.

The world I grew up in is dying. Four score and seven years ago began its zenith ascent. The forces of global democracy defeated global fascism across the Atlantic and Pacific. The descendants of the greatest years of the moral Papyrus Era were beneficiaries of a peace dividend. Phoenix rising, an entirely new phenomena, a middle-class with humanist values were confronting the historic stains of social inequalities. Proud boy, I was a drum n' bugle flag carrier for all that was noble in the world. *With my own eyes I have seen and touched heroes.*

In the Balkan badlands of Europe, news of the globe now grows darker by day. Three Fascisms. Political expropriation of national governments. Economic exploitation of indispensable necessities. Theocratic exhortations to impose supernatural extraterrestrial doctrines in place of the rule of law. Corruptively, by decades, a strange, amoral Digital Era is stealthily subsuming governments and the lives of people that they are charged to protect. Like the bullfrog eagerly consuming a poisonous snake, the sly snake's venom is in fact killing its prey. I intend to cut off its amoral head. *Are you with me?*



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